Cisco
Customer Experience

Cisco TAC
Best Practices & Innovations

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14/05/2026

Meet **Technical Assistance Center**

Fast facts

- **24/7** support
- **185+** countries served
- **3** TAC centres in EMEA
- **5,5k** SRs taken daily

Responsibilities

- ✓ **Service Requests**
- ✓ **Collaborations**
- ✓ **Bugs**
- ✓ **CXLAB recreates**
- ✓ Content Creation
- ✓ Automation (BDB/BORG)
- ✓ Rotations & CCIE Preparation
- ✓ Conferences & Trainings
- ✓ Beta tests

Special events

FIFA WORLD CUP Qatar2022 · THE CHAMPIONSHIPS WIMBLEDON · COP28 UAE · AFC ASIAN CUP · PARIS 2024

- Meet TAC organization
- Before opening the case
- CASE LIFECYCLE
  - Opening
  - Processing
  - Troubleshooting
  - Escalating
  - Closing
  - After closing
- Key takeaways
- TAC Innovations

What to do before opening the case?

01 **Cisco AI Assistant**
Use Cisco AI Assistant Tools

02 **Research online**
community.cisco.com

03 **Check Configuration Guides**

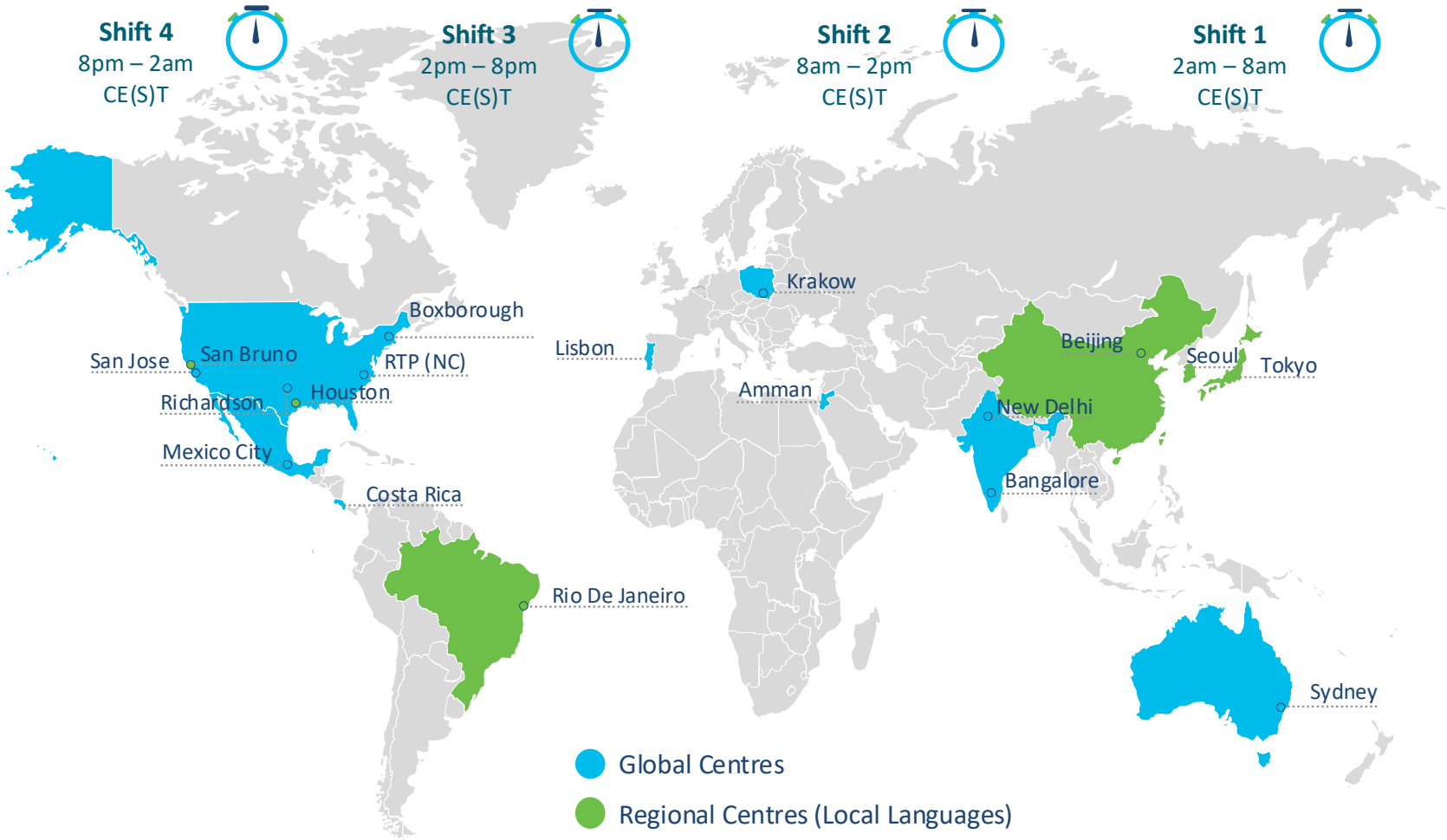
04 **Release notes and Field Notices (FN)**
List of related information with that version of produc
cisco.com/go/fieldnotices

05 **Bug Search Tool**
bst.cisco.com

06 **Check software version**
recommended for your hardware
software.cisco.com

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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
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After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

TAC 24/7/365 – Time Zones & Theatres



Always review the TAC engineers email signature for their location.

Meet TAC organization

Before opening the case

CASE LIFECYCLE

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Closing

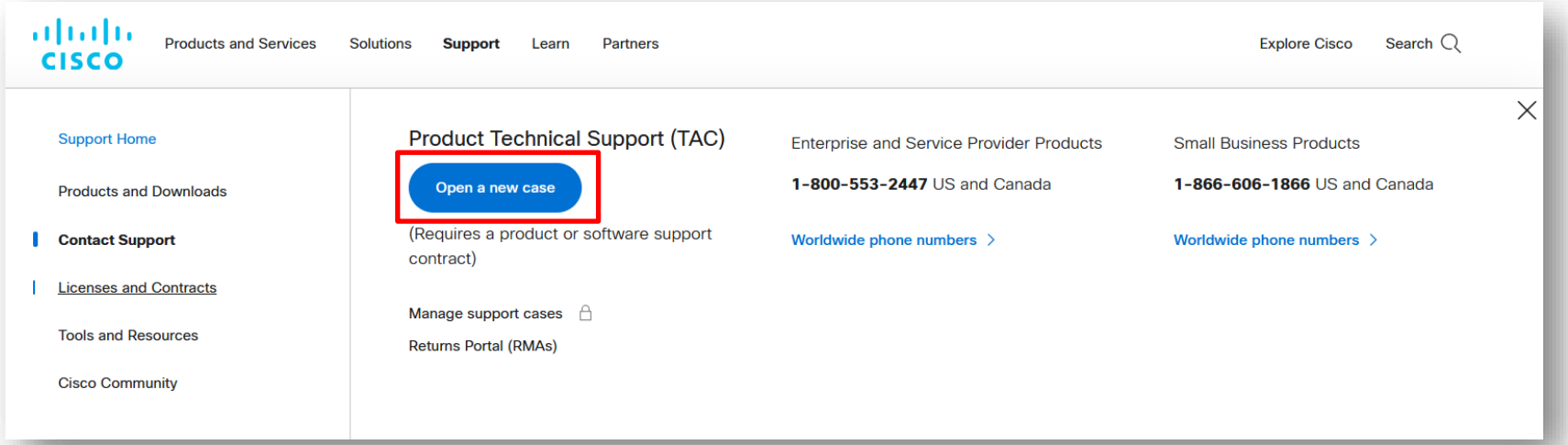
After closing

Key takeaways

TAC Innovations

Contact with TAC

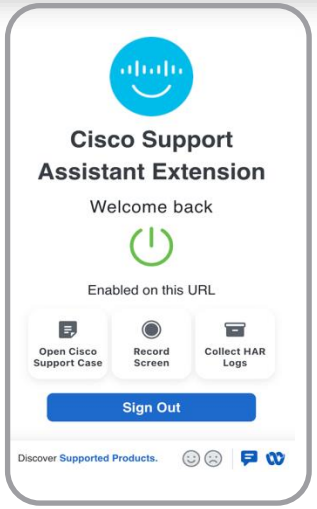
cisco.com



Europe +32 2 704 5555

By country (f.ex.):

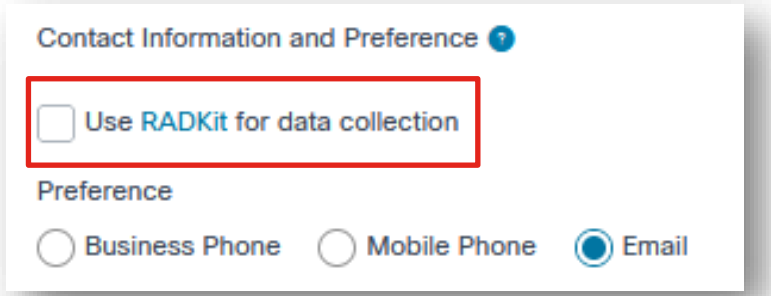
Belgium	0800 94242
Netherlands	0800 0200 791
Poland	0800 4411 932
UK	0800 404 7778

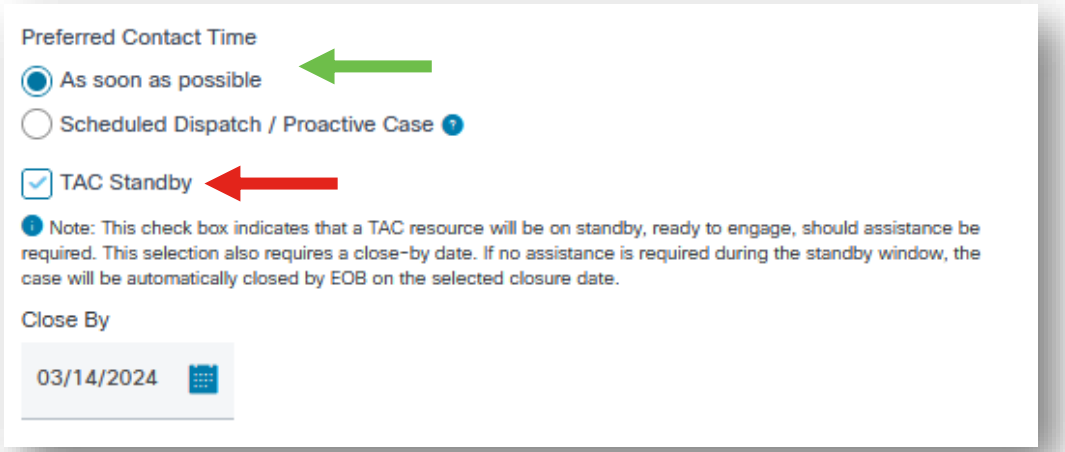


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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

Support Case Manager

cisco.com





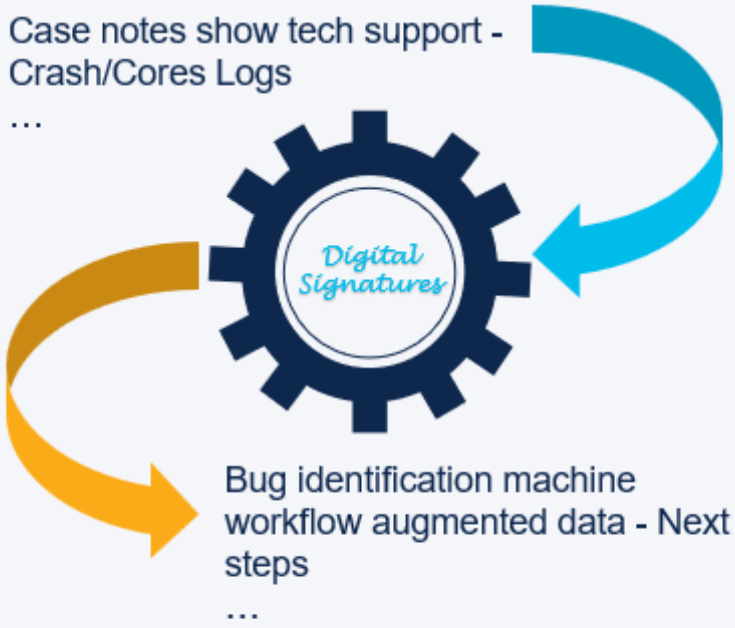
New fields in SCM form:

- **Use RADKit** for data collection
- Schedule Dispatch new Service Request on the time of your choice using **Preferred Contact Time** option
- Use **TAC Standby** to open proactive Service Request for standby support during maintenance window.

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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

TIP

Over **50,000** complete Digital Signatures today in our catalog



Faster resolution through immediate log analysis

What to include in the case?

- ✓ Detailed & Technical Problem Description
- ✓ **Urgency and business impact of the problem & deadlines (if any)**
- ✓ Software Version of affected product
- ✓ Hardware Platform and Serial Number
- ✓ Topology of the network
- ✓ Trigger (if any)
- ✓ Troubleshooting already done (if any)
- ✓ Technical logs from the system
- ✓ Logs from monitoring systems (if any)
- ✓ Time of first occurance of the issue
- ✓ Up-to-date contact information

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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

Problem description is key!

Secure Client is not working.

Vague description, no details.

Secure Client RA VPN sessions cannot be established by **random users** from **various locations**. **Multiple platforms** are affected.
The authentication method is **SAML**.

After providing credentials, the following error is displayed: **Authentication failure**.

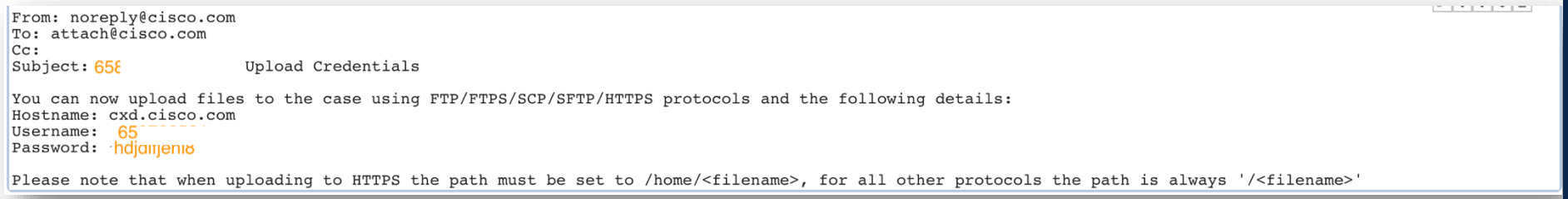
The issue is **intermittent**. **No recent changes** on the FTD side and in the network environment.
Local user authentication works fine.

Problem description includes a lot of details about the issue.

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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

Case uploads

- Email to **attach@cisco.com** with attachment (up to 20 MB)
- **Support case manager**: https://mycase.cloudapps.cisco.com/case (up to 250 GB)
- If you're not a case initiator - ask Cisco case owner to generate an **external upload link** for you
- **Cisco Support Assistant Extension**
- **Customer eXperience Drive** (no limit)
  - Multiprotocol (SCP/SFTP/FTPS/HTTPS/FTP) file transfer service
  - Utilities upload-only case-specific credentials
  - Allows to upload data directly from devices to TAC Cases
  - Automation tools running in no time!



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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
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Service Request [SR] Prioritization Guidelines



Urgent

Severity 1

- Production network down
- Critical impact to business operations
- 24-hour Cisco, Partner and Customer commitment

Severity 2

- Network severely degraded
- Significant impact to business operations
- Cisco, Partner and Customer committed during business hours

Non-Urgent

Severity 3

- Network functionality degraded
- Business operations noticeably impaired
- Cisco, Partner and Customer in frequent contact

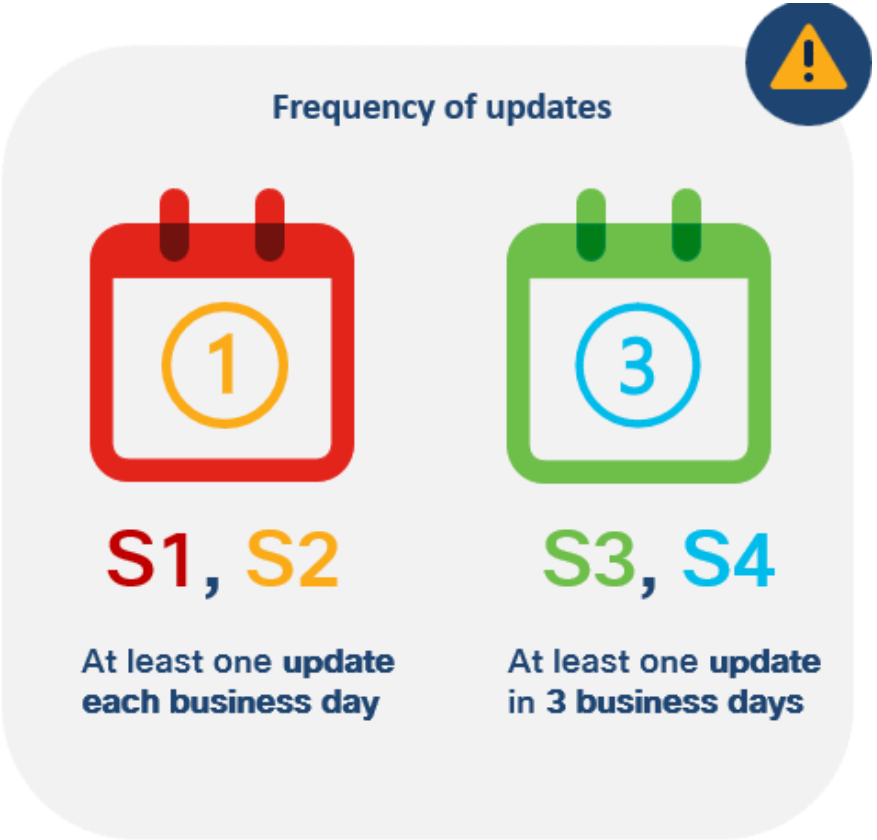
Severity 4

- General assistance – Ask a question
- Installation, upgrade, or configuration assistance
- General product information

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Before opening the ca
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

Working with TAC: Support on an opened SR

- New SRs and re-queued SRs are routed to the appropriate team queues.
- TCEs accept cases from their queue, within internally specified time limits.
- **Priority really matters**
- **Case Status** should clearly represent the status of the investigation.
- Email with attach@cisco.com **in CC** and **SR number in subject** changes status automatically.



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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
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Collaboration Types

- **Cross technology collaboration:**
  - Issue from different technology identified,
  - Owner stays the same unless you are notified that ownership has changed.
- **Follow the Sun**
  - Case transfer to the next timezone
  - Case owner should always change to the engineer who is on shift,
  - The FTS Assistant is simplifying the FTS process compliance,
  - Enables non-stop support for critical customer issues which directly impacts customer experience



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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
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SR Engineering Engagement

- Conversation with the Engineering team is internal

- Reasons for technical escalation:
  - logs/debugs are inconclusive
  - suspected new defect
  - request for special engineering release



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CASE LIFECYCLE

Opening

Processing

Troubleshooting

Escalating

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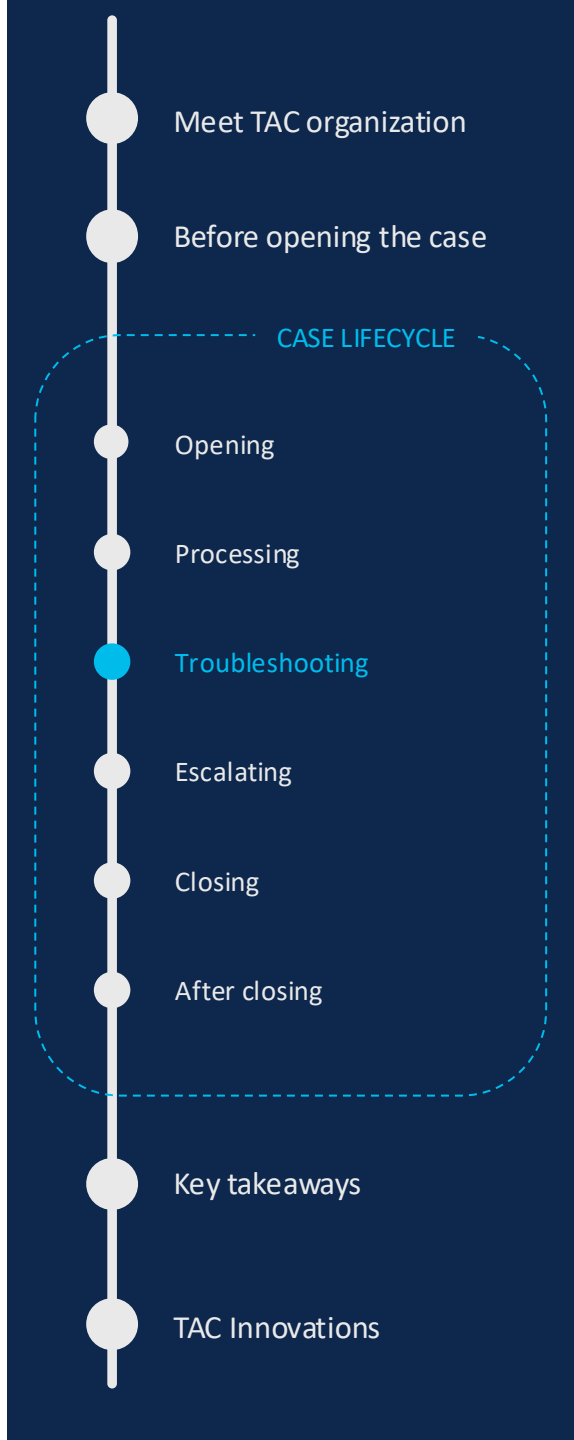
After closing

Key takeaways

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RMA – Customer Handoff

- When RMA is needed system will send a handoff email to the SR requester or Acknowledgment contact
- Click on “Complete your RMA” button in the email. This will take you to review & submit page on the RMA tool.
- Review all details including SITE Address before clicking Submit, to initiate delivery of the RMA.
- If you do not submit the draft RMA, you will get subsequent reminder emails to complete your draft RMA.
- Draft RMAs auto expire if action is not taken within 7 days of initiation



SR Management Escalations

If you feel that case must be escalated for management reasons, do not hesitate to contact engineer's manager (Delivery Leader).

Escalate using Cisco AI Assistant for Support at https://supportassistant.cisco.com/escalate, via Webex App, on Support Case Manager or Virtual Spaces.

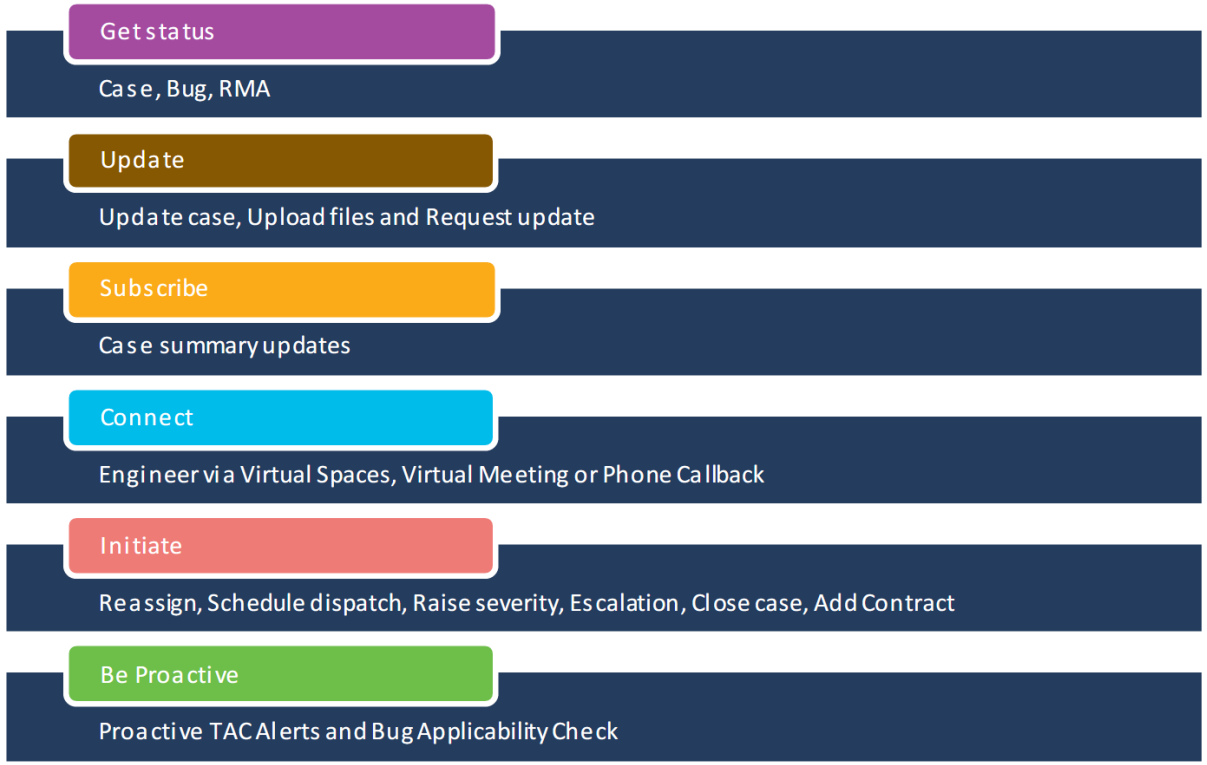
- Enter the case number
- Provide escalation reason
- Choose "Escalate to TAC Manager"
- Provide phone number for S1/S2 case or email address for S3/4 case

Meet TAC organization
Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

Cisco AI Assistant for Support

supportassistant.cisco.com/escalate

Cisco AI Assistant for Support offers customers and partners a self-service experience for common case inquiries and basic transactions. It even has the ability to connect customers with case owners and duty managers.

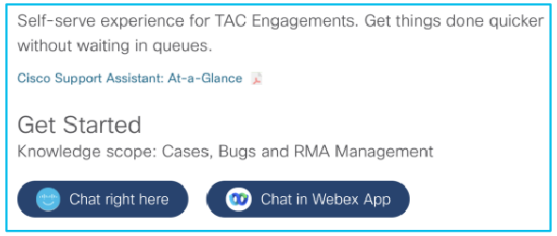


TIP How does it work**?** Check our **resources**: Cisco AI Assistant for Support

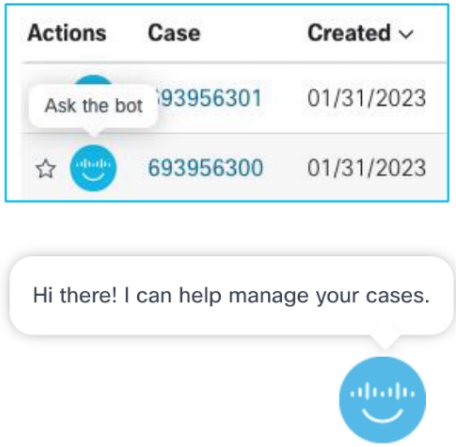
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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

How to interact with the Assistant?

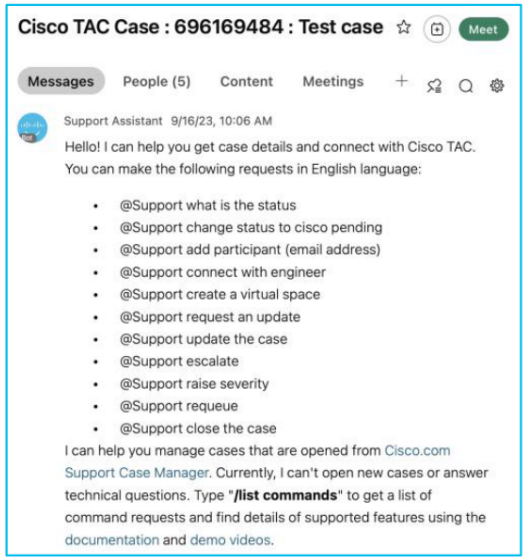
https://supportassistant.cisco.com



Support Case Manager



Virtual Spaces

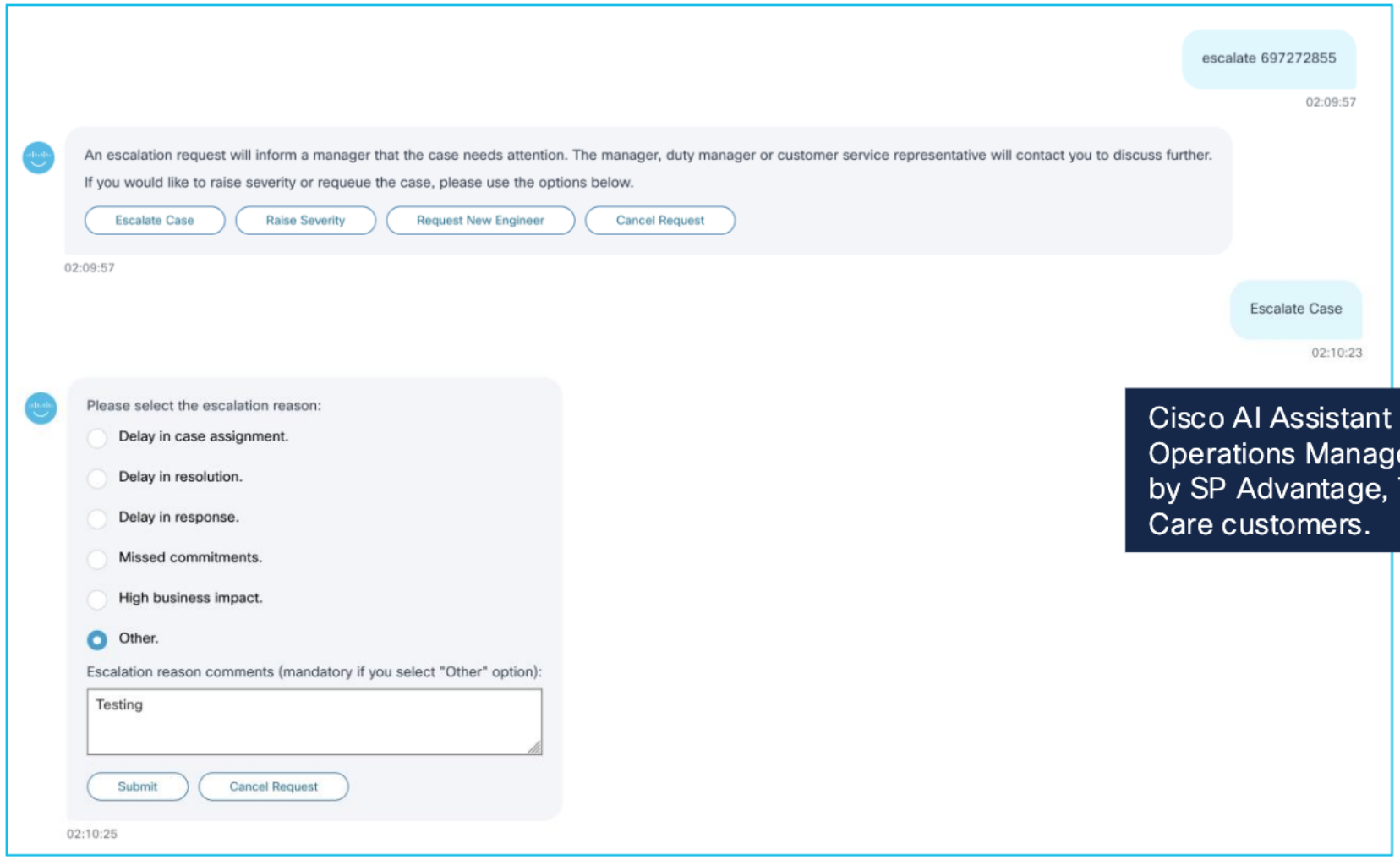


Use **@Support** to interact with the bot in virtual spaces created in the context of a case

TIP **Add Cisco Support Assistant to your Favourites contacts in Webex Teams.**

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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

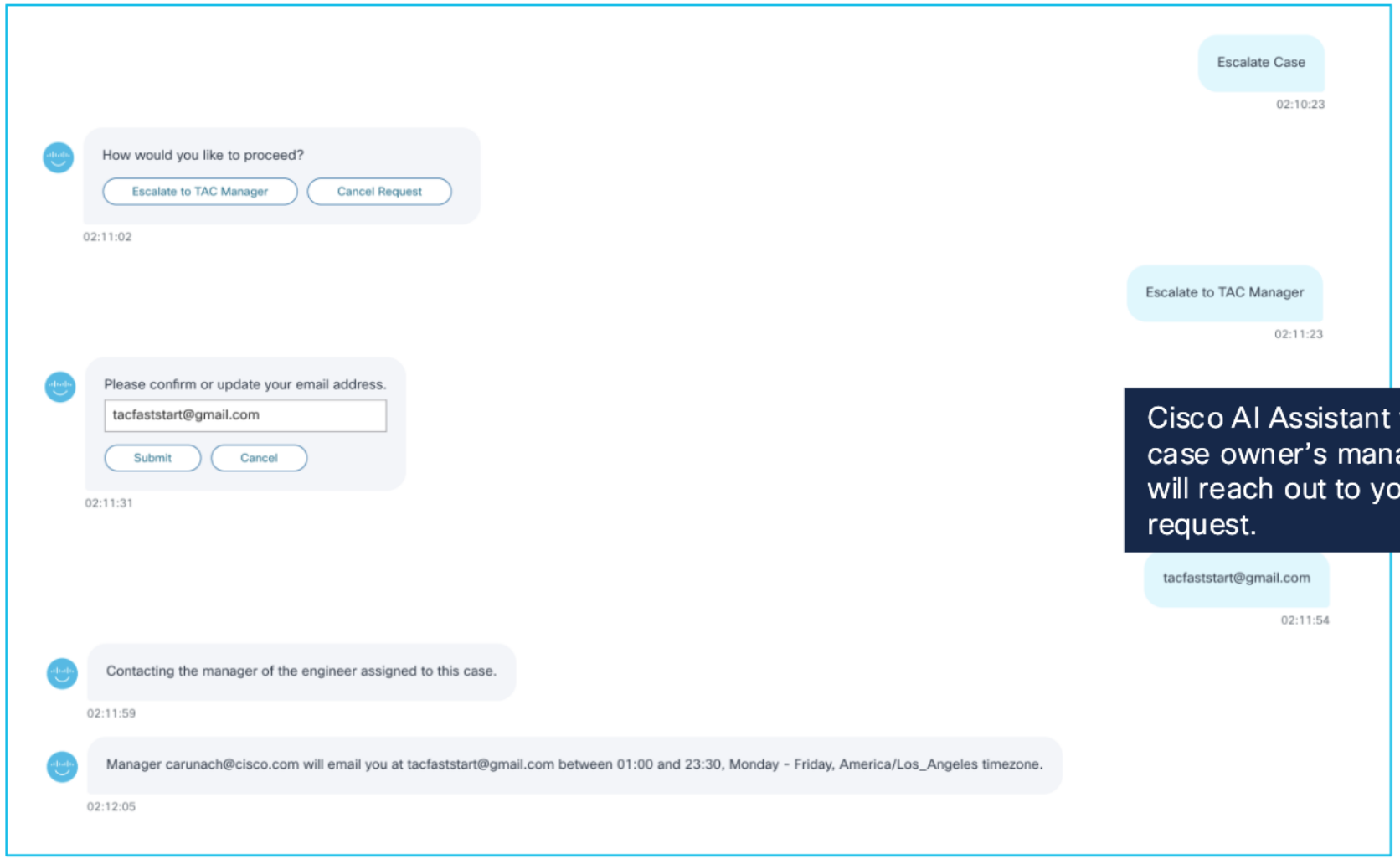
Escalating via Webex



Cisco AI Assistant for Support informs High Touch Operations Managers (HTOM) when a case is escalated by SP Advantage, TS Advantage or High Touch Expert Care customers.

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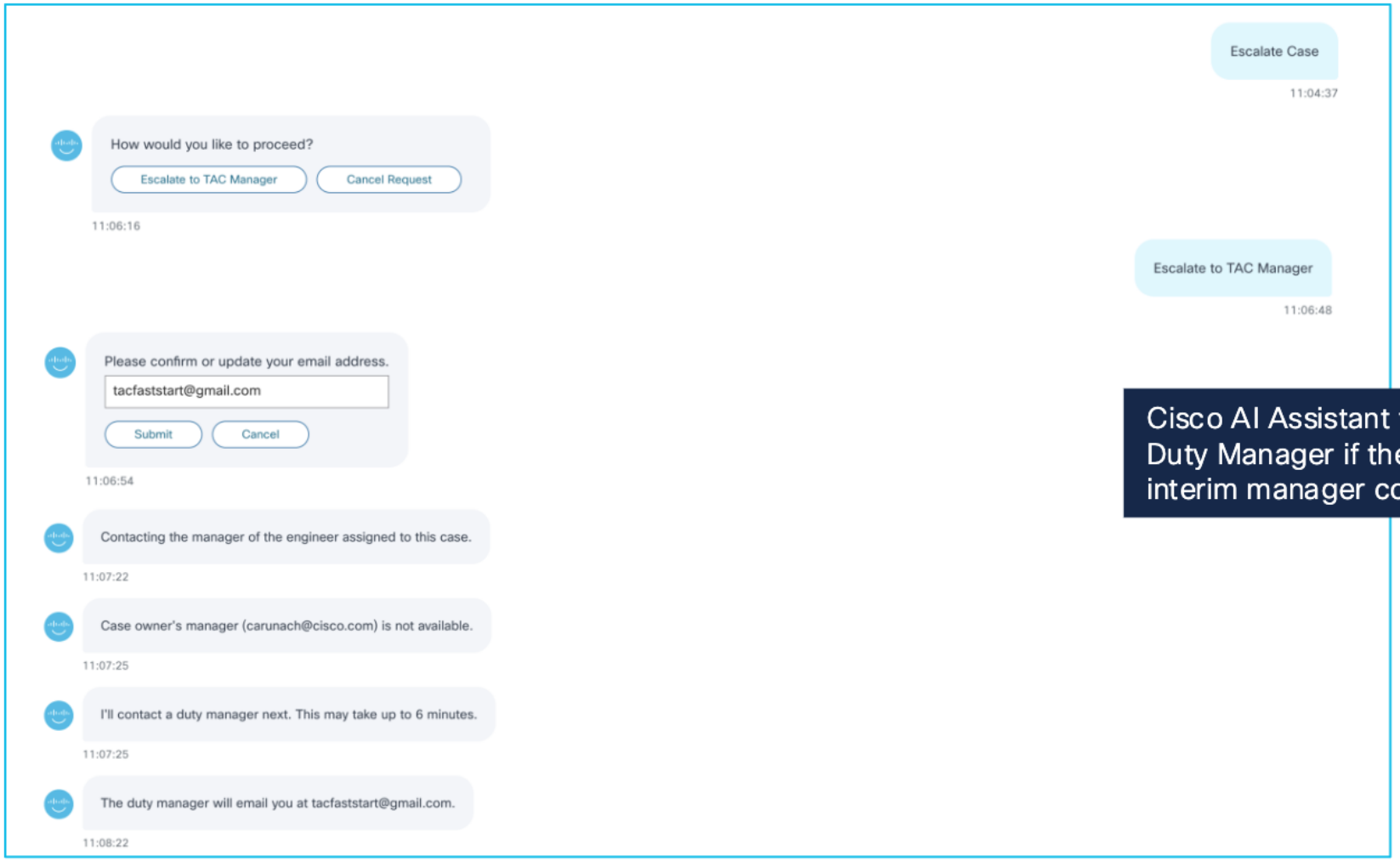
Escalating via Webex



Cisco AI Assistant for Support connects you with the case owner's manager or the interim manager who will reach out to you regarding the escalation request.

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Escalating via Webex



Cisco AI Assistant for Support connects you with TAC Duty Manager if the case owner's manager, or the interim manager contact is not available.

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Case closure

- CUSTOMER APPROVED
- NO RESPONSE: 3 STRIKE RULE

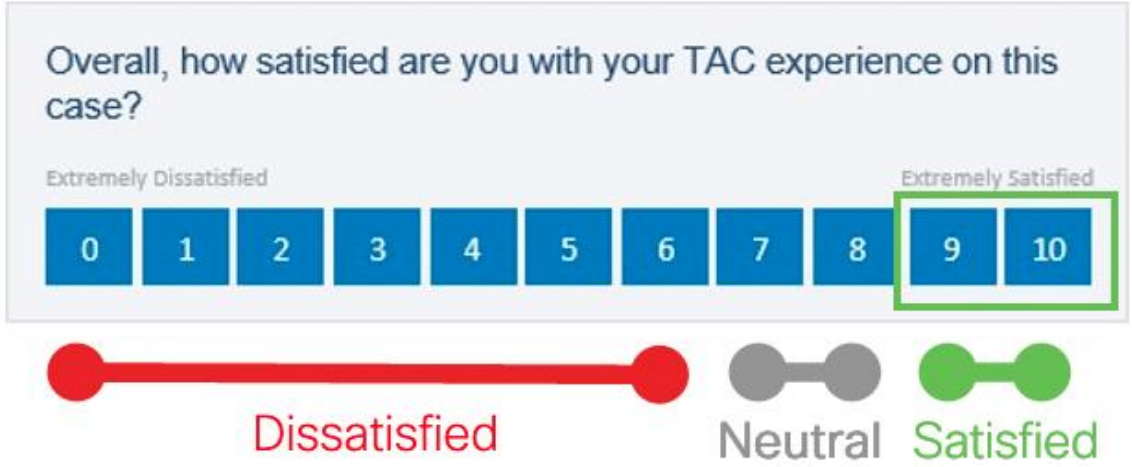
** Within 14 Days after closure: Reopen the same case



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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

TAC Satisfaction Survey:

Help us continually improve

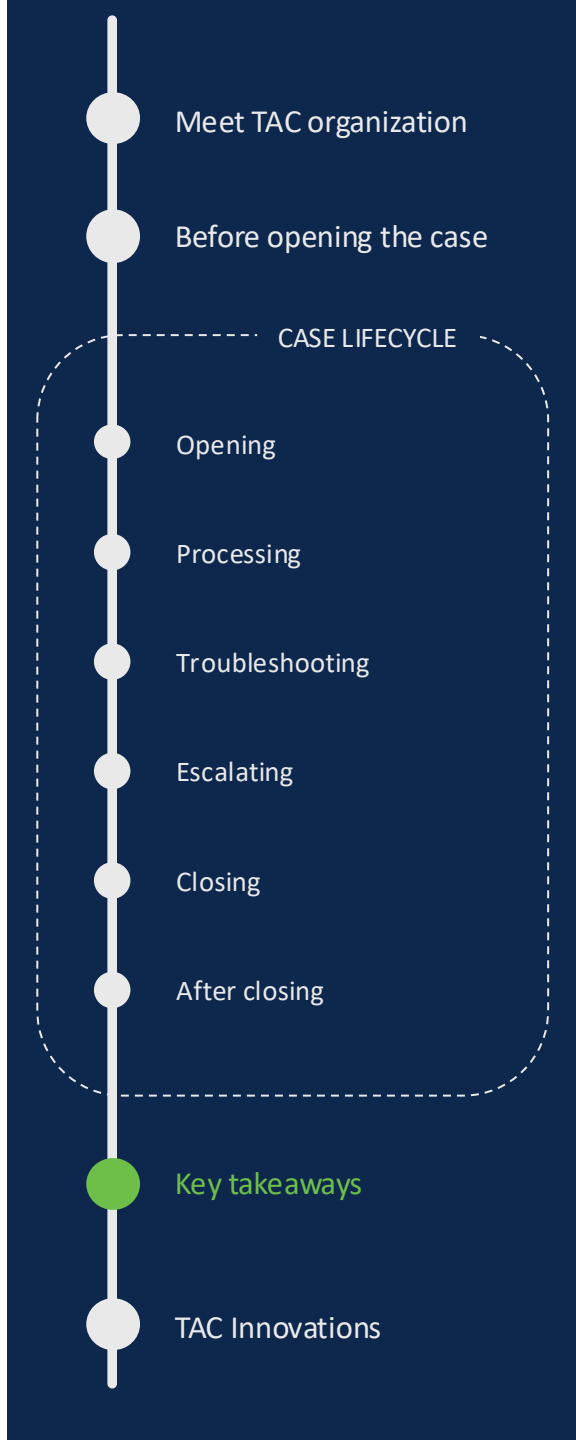


- Customer satisfaction survey generated upon Service Request (SR) closure
- Additional feedback can be shared but not mandatory
- Analysis is conducted on the feedback received;
  Follow-up on low scores

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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

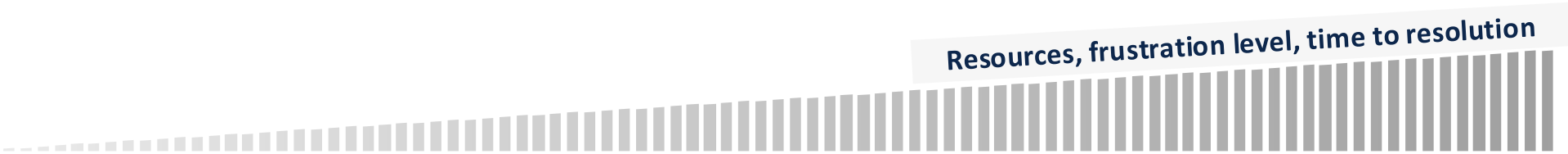
General Guidelines

- **One case in TAC = one problem. Do not mix different problems** in one case.
- If you encounter **new problems** in ongoing Service Request, the TAC engineer will advise to open separate case.
- TAC is **"break/fix" support (day2).** For design/implementation (day0/1) requests, you will be advised to reach out to the appropriate Account Team regarding Professional Services.
- **You are in control** of Service Request's Severity.
- If Business Impact of the issue changed and you wish to change to Severity 2 or Severity 1, it is best practice to **do it over the phone, not e-mail.**



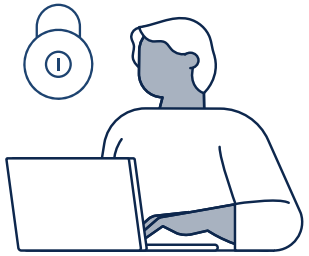
Technical Support *innovations*

Current Troubleshooting Method



Case open > Progress > Done

Original | Email > Email > Email & call & Webex | Issue clear



- Initial response
- Engineer information
- Request for issue description and basic information collection

- Issue description
- Basic Information collection and send

- TAC - Request for additional information collection & analysis iteration
- Customer - Iterative collection and send of additional information
- Customer - Environment setup for real-time remote troubleshooting
- Increase in lead time in the event of customer and partner support delays



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RADKit Boosts Troubleshooting Experience

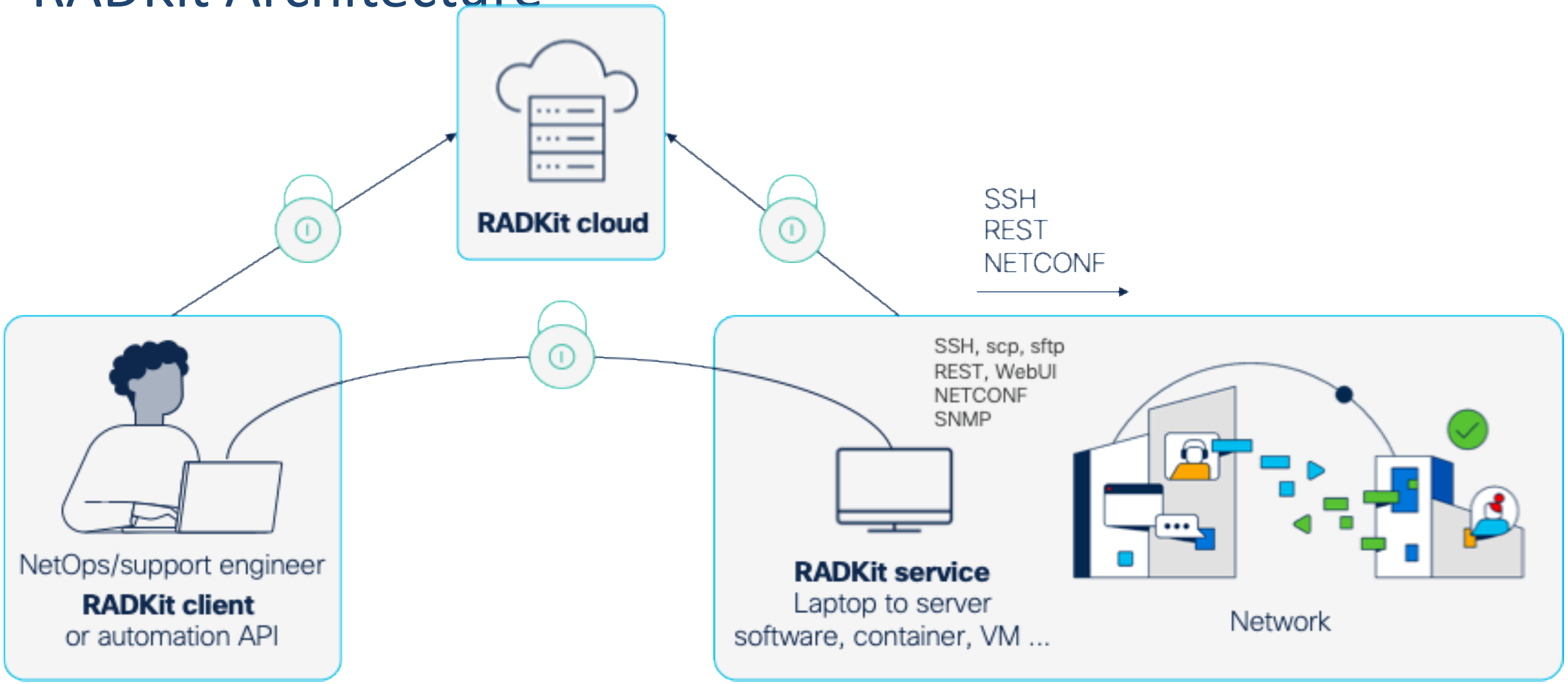
Case open → Progress → Done

	TAC	Customer	TAC & Customer	
Original	Email	Email	Email & call & Webex	Issue clear
	• Initial response • Engineer information • Request for issue description and basic information collection	• Issue description • Basic Information collection and send	• TAC - Request for additional information collection & analysis iteration • Customer - Iterative collection and send of additional information • Customer - Environment setup for real-time remote troubleshooting • Increase in lead time in the event of customer and partner support delays.	
RADKit	Email	Easy Email	Simplify RADKit	Issue clear
	• Initial response • Engineer information • Request for issue description and RADKit information	• Issue description • RADKit access setting and Information send	• TAC - Direct collection and upload of required information • TAC - Real-time remote support & Webex setup	

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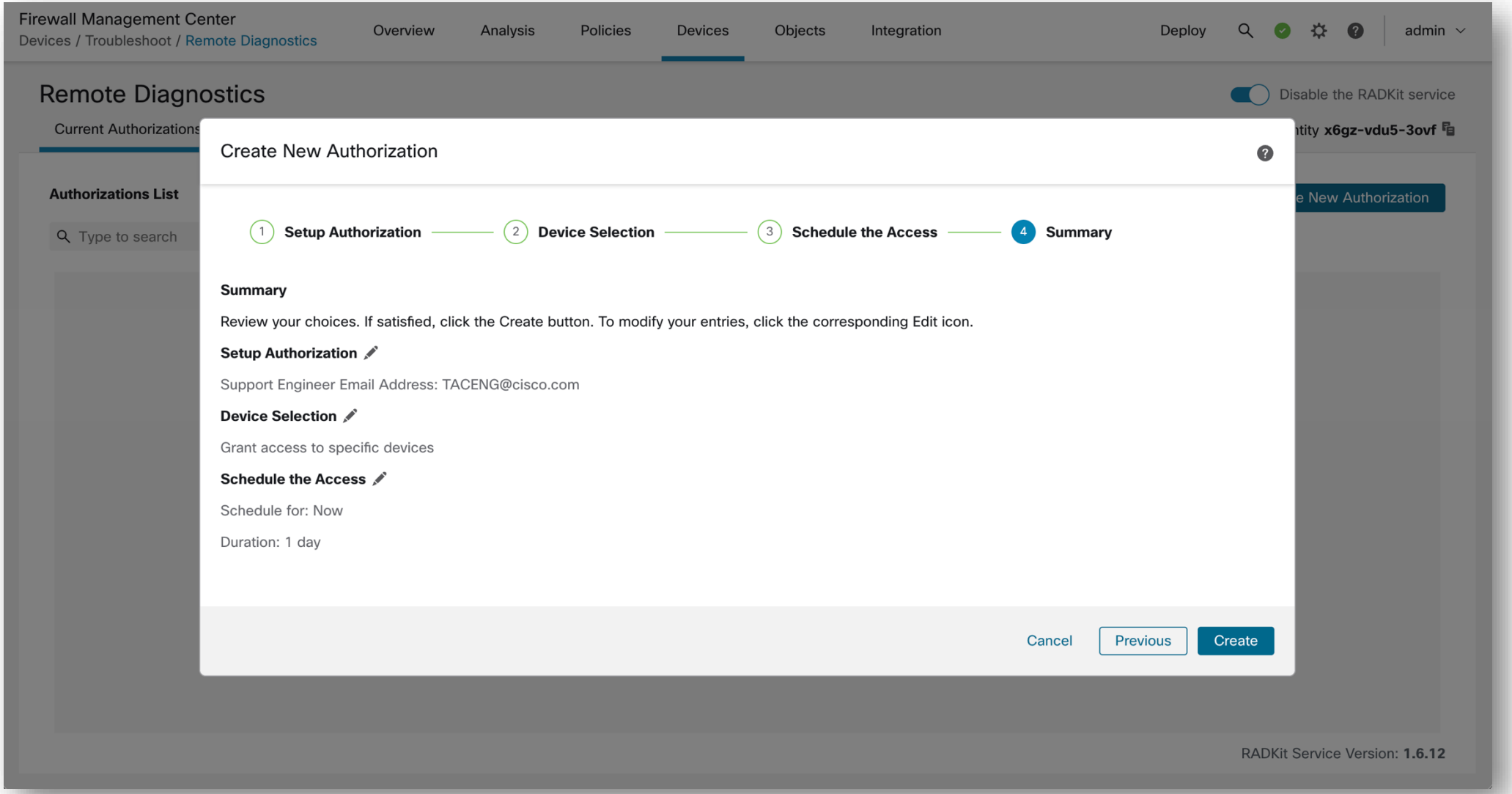
RADKit Architecture



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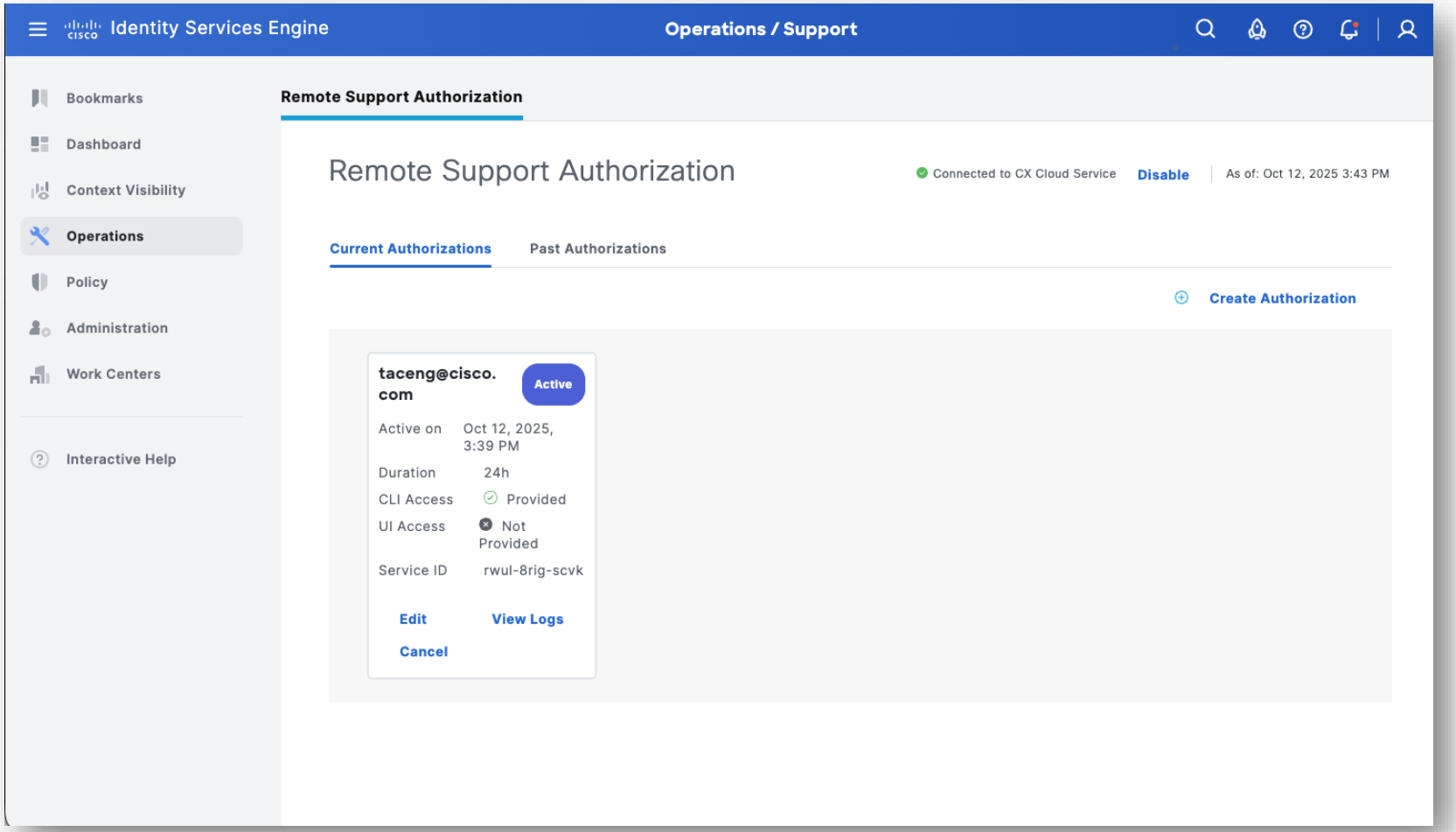
Built-in RADKit Secure Firewall Management Center



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Built-in RADKit ISE

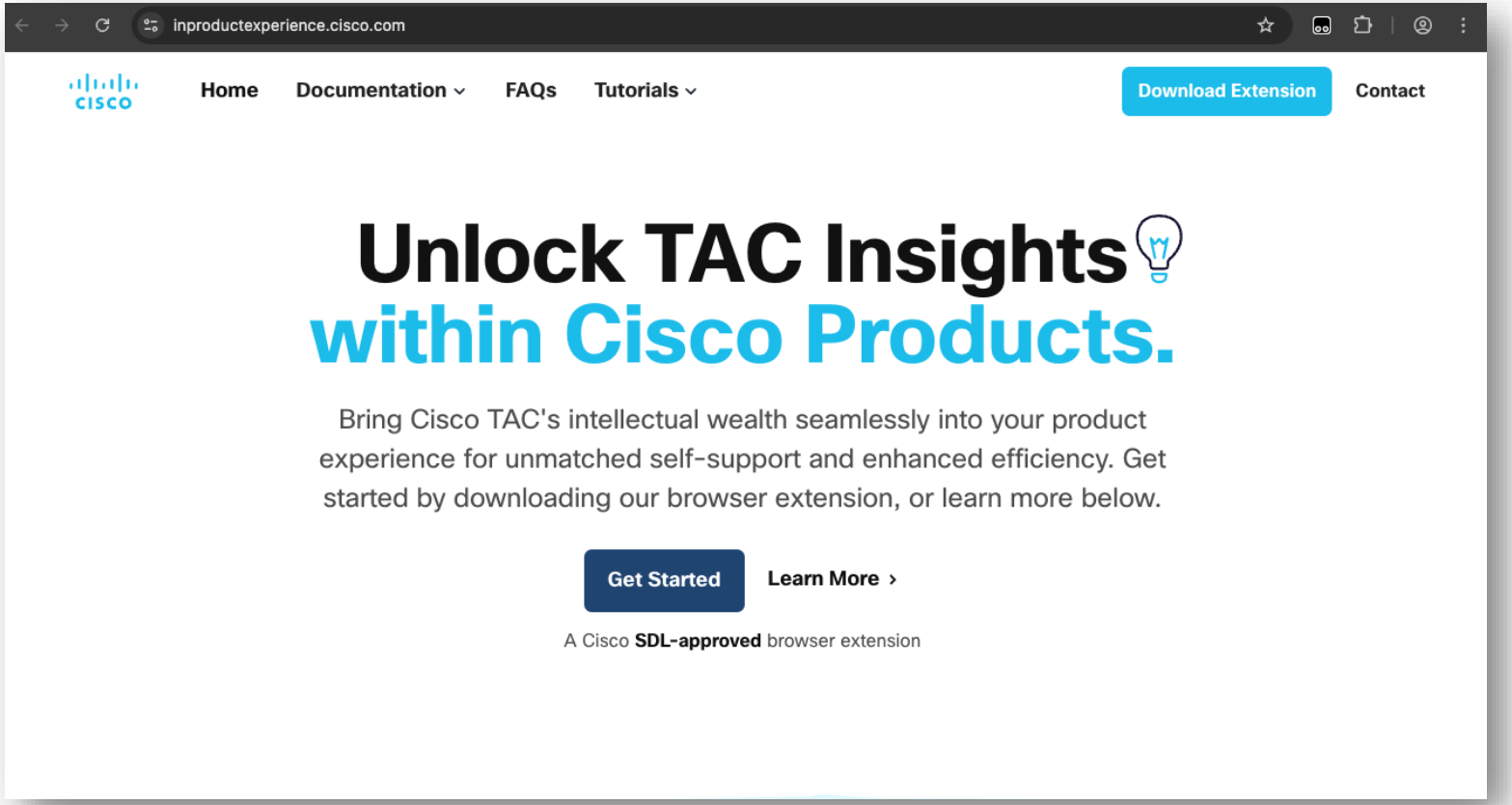


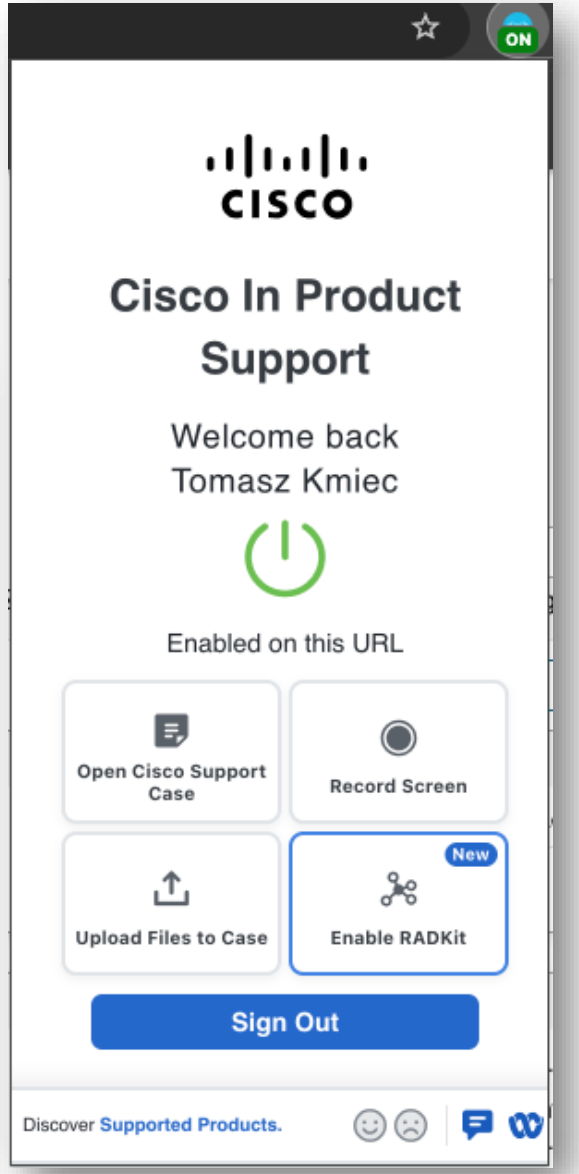
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In-product Experience

- Designed to organically appear within product portals as needed.
- Geared to enhance self-service capabilities for faster solutions.
- Aimed to optimize your support interactions and workflows.

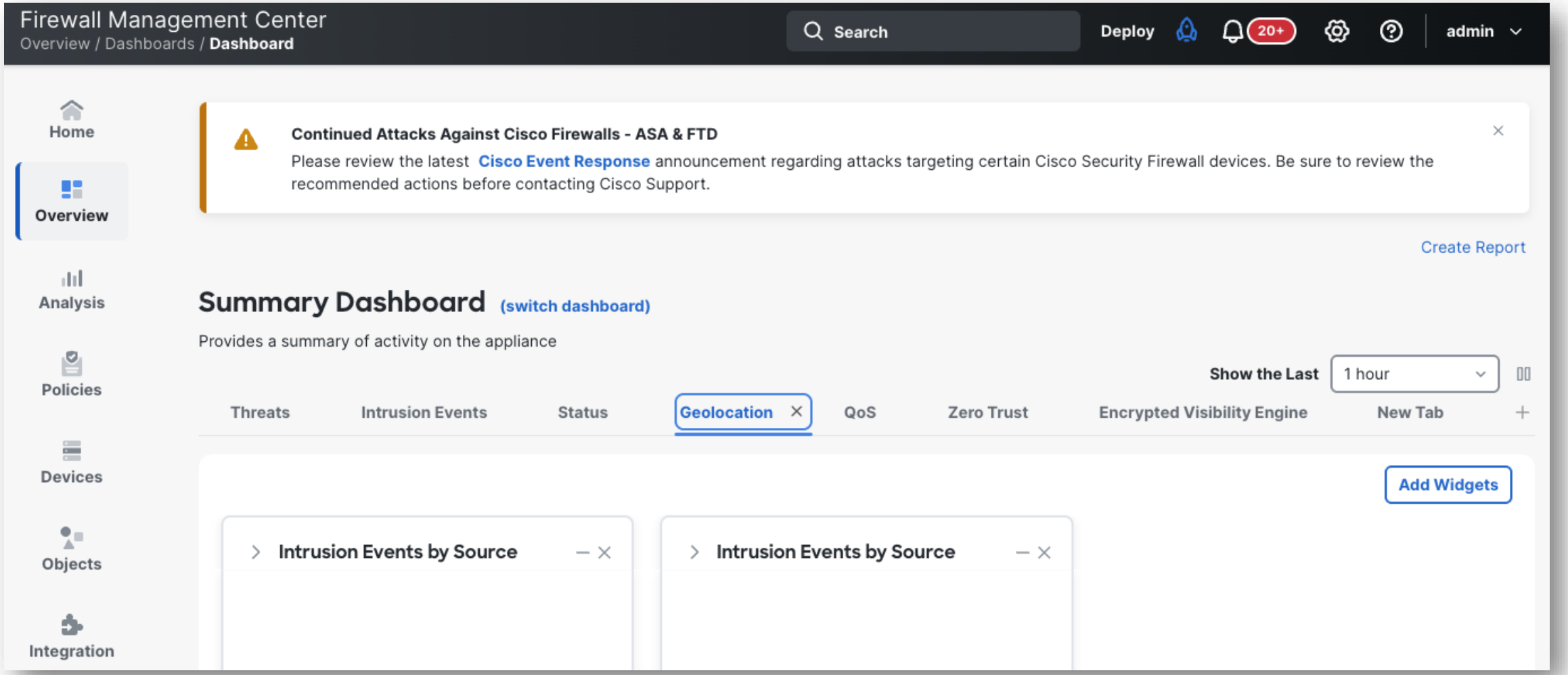




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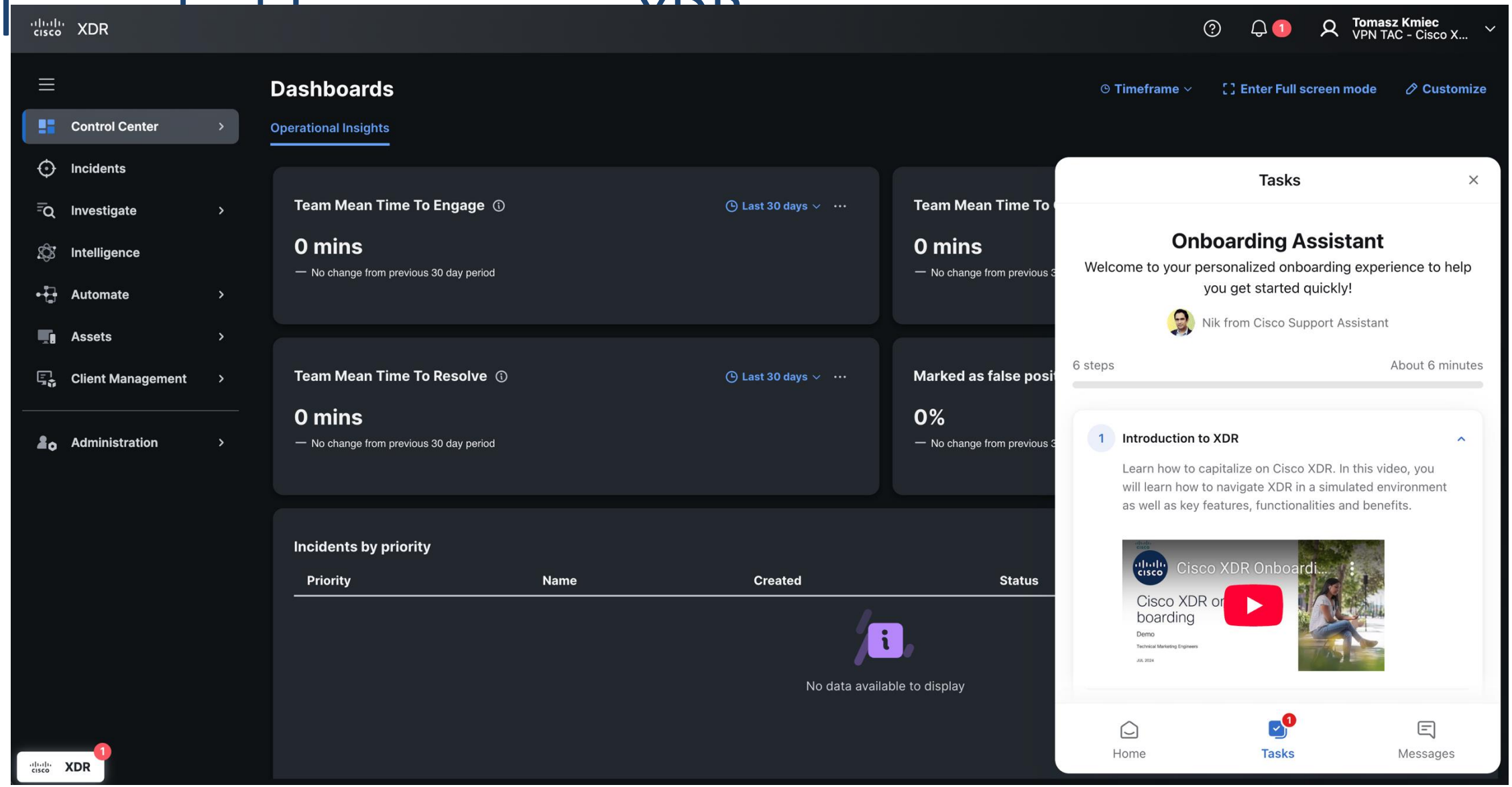
In-product Experience – Secure Firewall



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Improved UI Experience - XDR

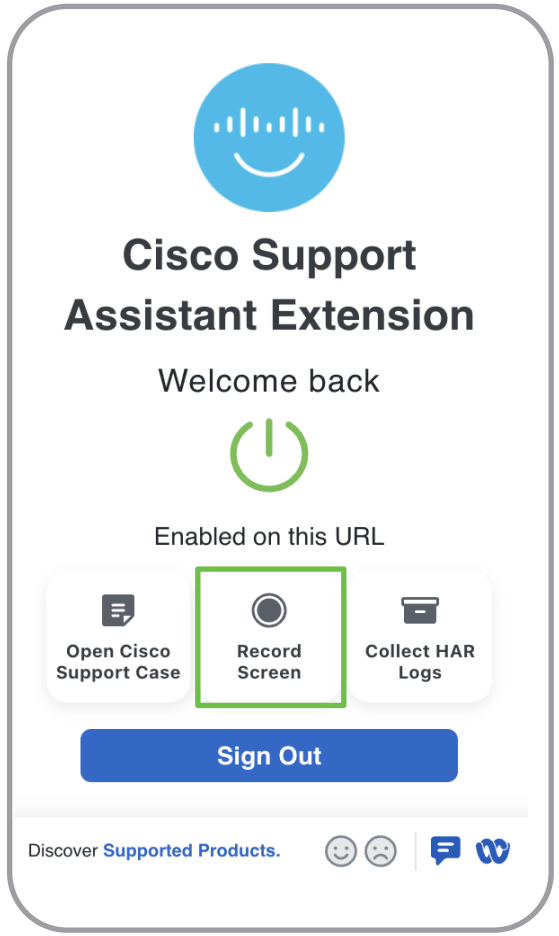


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Cisco Support Assistant Extension

Use case 1: Screen Recording

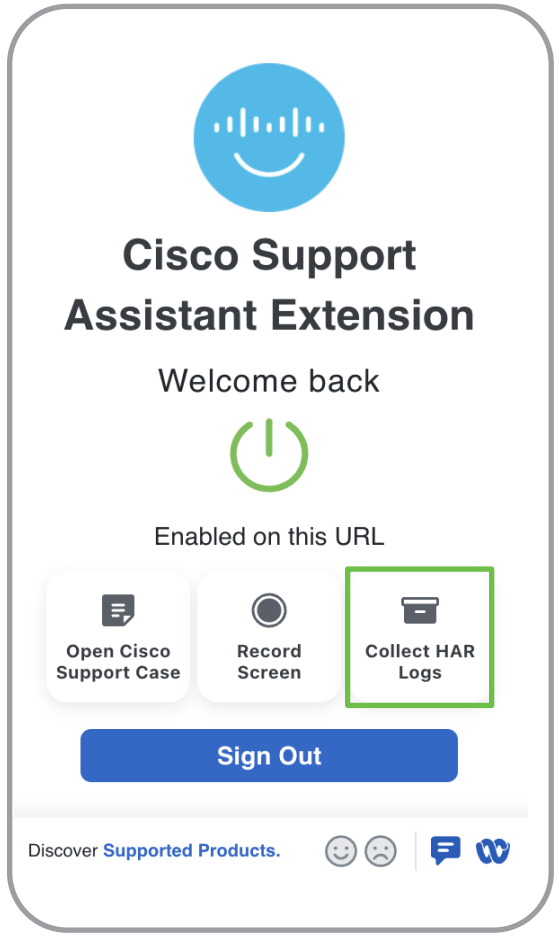


CSA Extension enables the recording of actions taken in UI, helping TAC engineers gain
a clearer understanding of the issue.

Meet TAC organization
Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

Cisco Support Assistant Extension

Use case 2: Browser logs (HAR file) collection

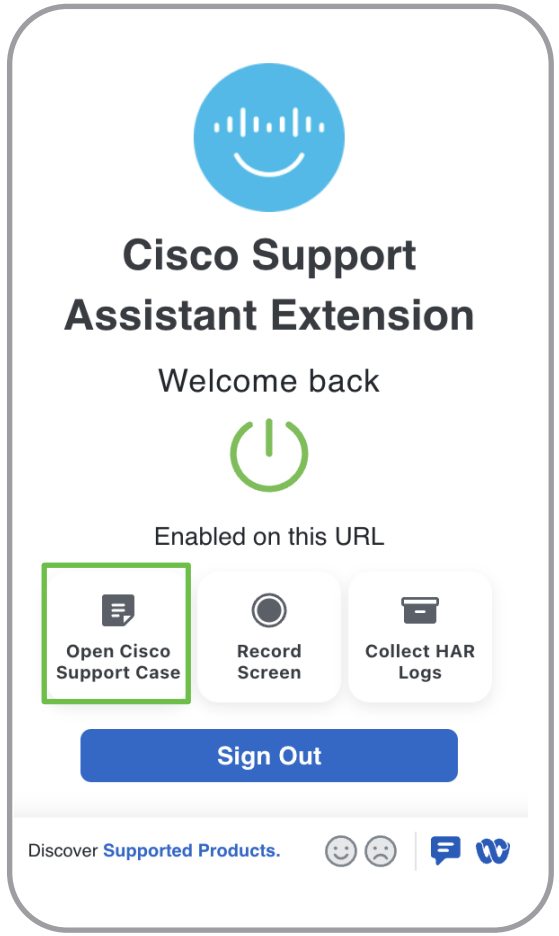


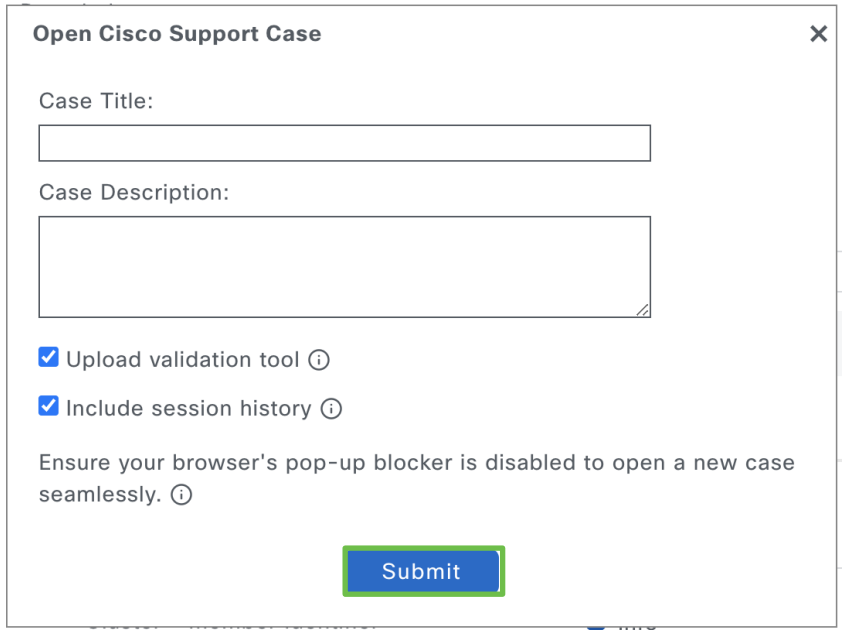
CSA Extension allows for easy collection of browser HAR (HTTP Archive) files during UI troubleshooting, eliminating the need to access browser developer tools and collect all required data manually.

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Before opening the case
CASE LIFECYCLE
Opening
Processing
Troubleshooting
Escalating
Closing
After closing
Key takeaways
TAC Innovations

Cisco Support Assistant Extension

Use case 3: Case opening

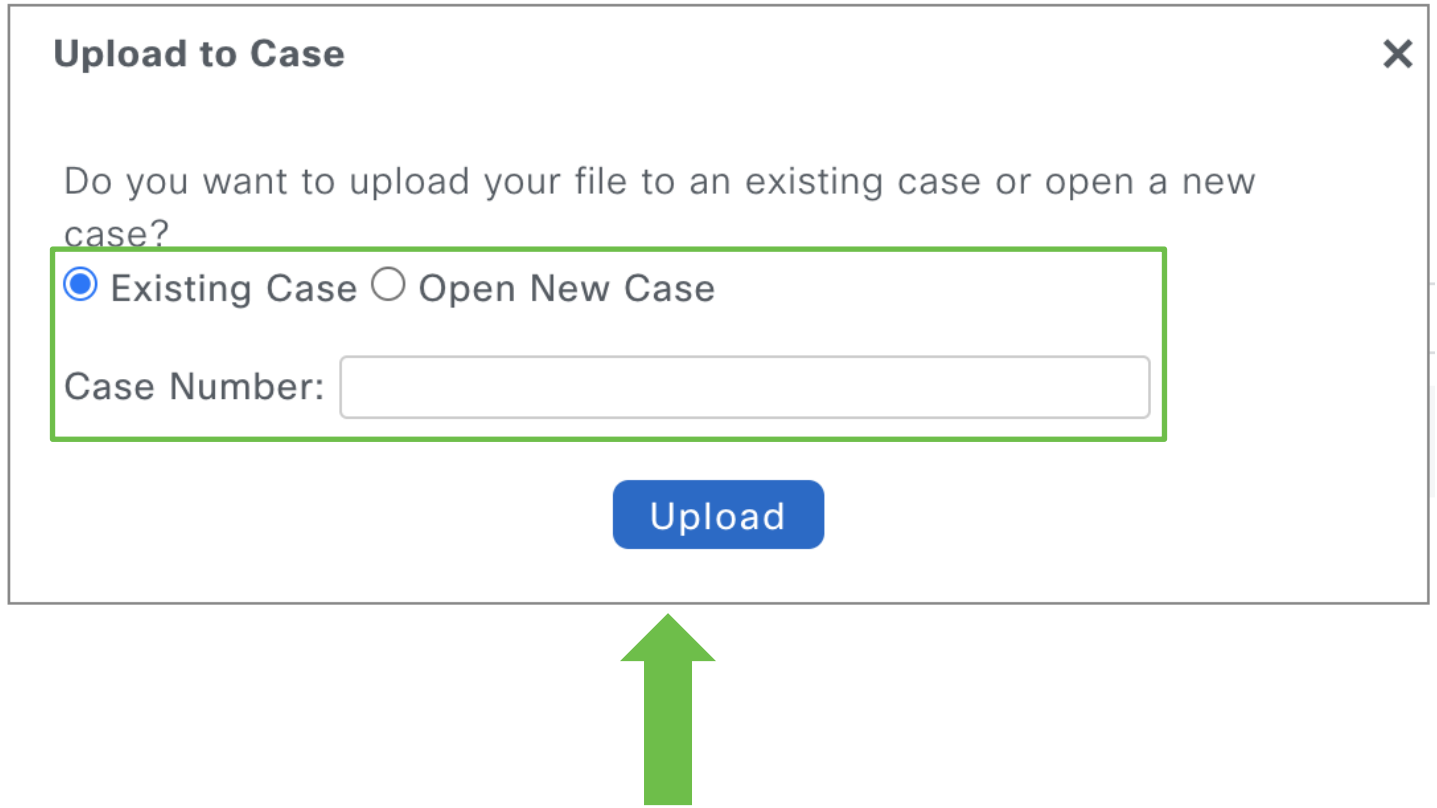




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Use case 4: Direct file upload to Support Case



Two options:

a) Attach file to the existing case

b) Open a new case.

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Processing
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Case Assistant - Sherlock

- Digital TAC engineer supervised by TAC engineers.
- Works around the clock.
- All actions monitored and overwatched.

Sample Case

Tue @ 02:24 am - Customer
Opens SR
"Received the following error default Keyring's certificate..."

Sherlock
- Tue @ 02:26 am **Takes SR**

Sherlock- Tue @ 02:37 am *"To regenerate the certificate, please do the following..."*

Tue @ 03:13am - Customer
"The issue is resolved. You may close this ticket"

49 min from open to resolution

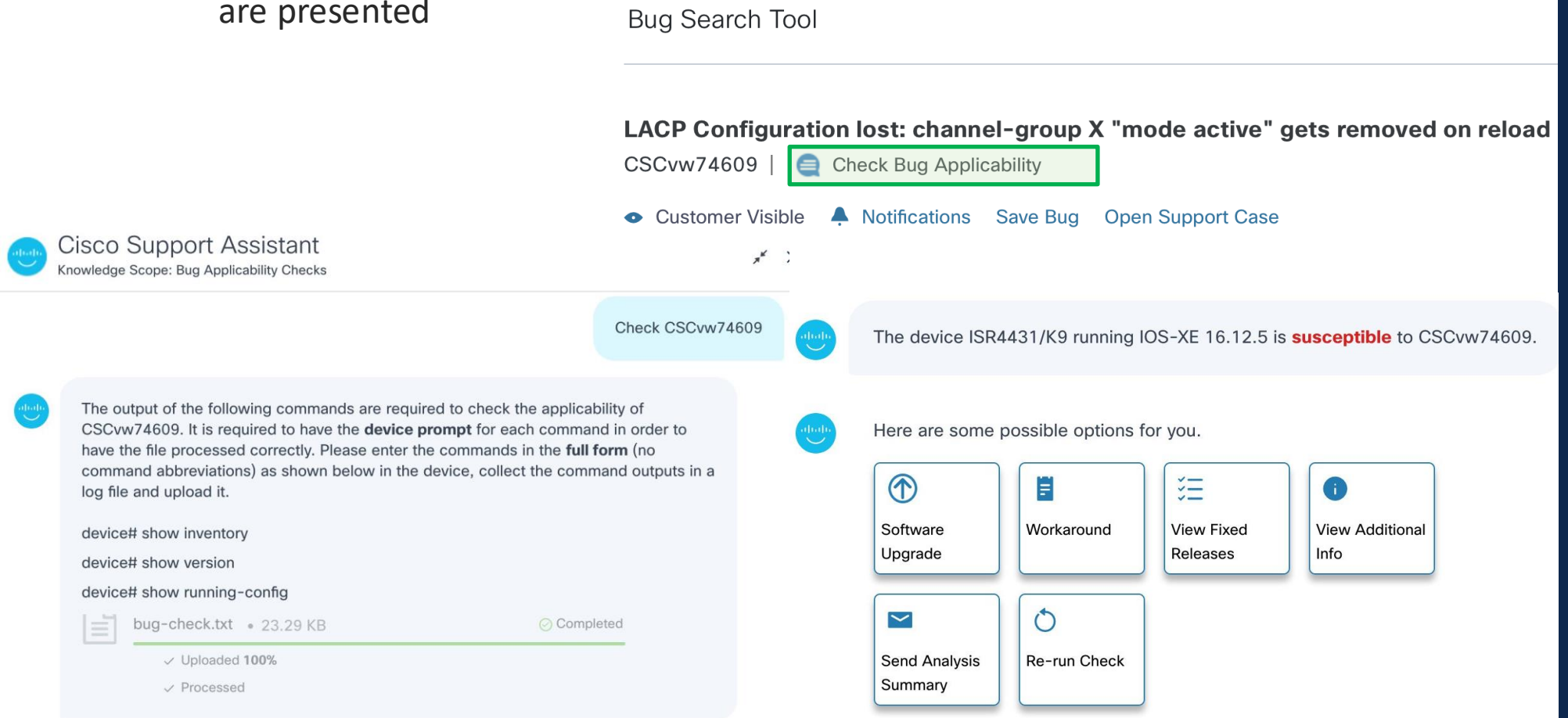
Sherlock- Tue @ 04:17 am
Starts closing timer

24-hour hold timer



Cisco Support Assistant Bug Applicability Checks

- Validate if a bug is applicable to a specific device
- Upload diagnostics data required to perform the check
- If the bug is applicable the available options to mitigate the bug are presented

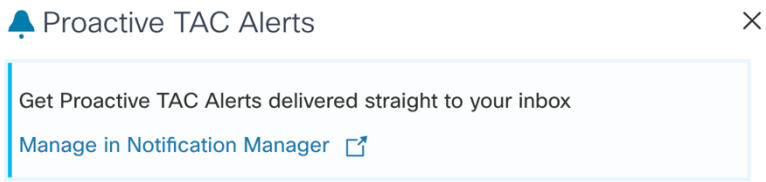


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Cisco Support Assistant Proactive TAC Alerts

https://cloud.path.cisco.com/notification-center-csa

- Users can subscribe to bi-weekly email alerts about trending issues, tool updates and articles updates related to products of interests.
- The same alert would be sent max twice
- Users can acknowledge alerts in CSA



Support

Active | Proactive Technical Assistance Center (TAC) Alerts

Emails about issues and tool updates for your products of interest, based on TAC cases you've opened within the past 12 months.

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Opening
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Tips and Tricks



TAC is working 24/7/365



Use AI Assistant, Radkit and Extension



Consider case requeue when required



Answer all questions asked by TCE



Emphasize on your business impact (and possible deadlines)



Use the right severity



For Escalations: Delivery Leader / Duty Manager

Meet TAC organization

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Summary: useful links and contacts

	Self service (online tools and resources)	Not urgent **Severity 3-4**	Urgent **Severity 1-2**
Wordwide Support Contacts		✓	✓
Support Case Manager (Service Request Tool)		✓	✓
Support Assistant (Status / Escalation Chat)		✓	✓
Support and Downloads	✓		
Tools and Resources	✓		
Technology and Support Community	✓		
Request a Cisco RADKit Demo	✓		
Cisco Support Assistance Extension	✓		

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Troubleshooting
Escalating
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After closing
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TAC Innovations


Cisco
Customer Experience